

Sales Training Debrief — Session 21

Urgency. Hold the Line. Close the Loop Today.

Sales training led by Corie Dawson, Director · Tuesday 2 June 2026 · Marketing Sweet

1. What urgency actually means

The first principle of the session: urgency is not a feeling, it's a tempo. When a deal is in front of you and the buyer is engaged, your pace should match the pace of a deadline you can't push back. Move now, keep moving, don't break the rhythm. Most reps confuse urgency with panic — they get urgent at the wrong moment (when they think they're about to lose the deal) instead of at the right moment (when they're about to win it).

"Urgency is the same intensity you bring to anything that genuinely can't wait. If a deal is live and the buyer is engaged, that's the tempo."

The rule:

- When a buyer is engaged and asking questions, treat the next 60 minutes as the deal window — not the next week.
- Speed of response is part of the product. A 5-minute callback signals professionalism; a 24-hour callback signals indifference.
- The buyer's desire to speak to you decays steeply from the moment you hang up. Every hour that passes is a hill the rep has to climb back.

2. Hold the line — or call back in five

The mechanic that creates urgency on the call: when a buyer asks a question the rep doesn't have the answer to, the rep does not say "let me get back to you tomorrow." The rep says one of two things: "hold the line, I'll find out now," or "I'll call you back in five minutes." Both keep the deal hot.

The five-minute protocol:

1. Buyer asks a question — "can I pay cash up front?" / "can I do it across two months?" / "can you knock something off?"
2. Rep says: "Let me give you a call back in five minutes — I'll find out now."
3. Rep hangs up. Rep does not actually need to find anything out — the call-back is the manoeuvre, not the research.
4. Rep calls back inside five minutes with: "I've got some great news — the director said we can do one better for you."

Why the five-minute callback works:

- It tests engagement. If the buyer picks up, they're still interested. If they don't, they were never going to close today.
- It creates a new reason to re-engage. The rep isn't calling back to chase — they're calling back with news the buyer wants to hear.
- It demonstrates the rep can move fast on the buyer's behalf — which is part of the product the buyer is evaluating.

3. The director move — "I can do one better for you"

The single most important phrase in the callback. The rep doesn't come back with a smaller version of what was already offered. They come back with something better — a free month of hosting, an extra deliverable, a small bonus the buyer didn't ask for. The buyer was expecting a routine callback. They get a small gift instead. That changes the dynamic of the next ten minutes.

"I've gone one step better than just getting it organised for you. The director said we can give you a free month, just let us know — no rush, by the end of the week, as you planned."

Anatomy of the move:

- Frame the bonus as something the director authorised — not something the rep is giving away.
- Combine the bonus with a soft no-pressure line — "no rush, by the end of the week, as you planned." The bonus is the value; the relaxed close is the trust.
- Don't make the buyer earn it. The whole point of the move is that they didn't have to push for it.
- Use it once. Burning this move twice in a week reads as a discount tactic, not a director relationship.

4. Interest decays — the cliff

The mental model the session repeated several times. From the moment the buyer hangs up, their interest in the deal does not stay flat — it falls off a cliff. The drop is steep in the first few hours, then long and slow after that. The hill the rep has to climb back grows every hour.

STAGE	BUYER'S ENGAGEMENT LEVEL
During the live call	Peak — fully engaged, brain on the deal.
First 5 minutes after hang-up	Still warm — would pick up the callback without hesitation.
First hour	Dropping fast — buyer's attention has moved elsewhere.
Same day, evening	Half what it was. Other priorities have taken over.
Next day	A quarter at best. Rep has to re-sell the entire premise.
By Friday (if the call was Monday)	Cold. The deal is essentially a fresh pitch with a stale opener.

"His desire to speak to you is falling off a cliff. He's going down like a stone. That's why you call back inside five — because every minute past that, you're climbing back uphill."

5. Close on Monday — Friday is just confirmation

The implication of the cliff. If the buyer says "I'll decide by Friday," the rep's job isn't to wait for Friday — it's to get the deal locked in earlier so Friday becomes the confirmation, not the close. By Friday, the buyer has been thinking for four days, the urgency has gone, the alternatives have surfaced, and the deal that was hot on Monday is now a maybe.

"You should be closing it on Monday so you walk into Friday and it's done. You should not be praying that you can resuscitate something that's had four days to rest. It gets worse, not better."

The reframe:

- "Friday" is the buyer's comfort answer. It's rarely a real commitment date.
- The rep's job is to compress the decision window into the conversation that's already happening, not to defer it.
- If the buyer genuinely needs Friday (legitimate reason — accountant, partner, holiday) the rep accepts that and applies urgency to set up the Friday call as a confirmation, not a decision.

6. The text-message recovery

When a phone call goes unanswered, the rep doesn't call back ten times. They send one short text that re-opens the door without pressure. The text contains exactly two things: a hook (the better offer) and a soft re-engagement ("drop me a line"). The buyer can re-engage on their own terms — which is exactly what defuses the awkwardness of a missed call.

"Spoke to the director. I can do one better for you. Drop me a line."

Why this works:

- It removes the question of "why didn't they pick up." The rep doesn't need to know.
- It gives the buyer a reason to come back to the rep — not the other way around.
- It's casual. "Drop me a line" is permission to respond at the buyer's pace, which paradoxically makes most buyers respond faster.
- It positions the rep as someone who solved something for the buyer, not someone who's chasing.

7. Easy yeses can be decoys

A counter-intuitive principle. When a buyer is suddenly very keen — wants to pay up-front, wants the bigger package, wants to start tomorrow — the rep's instinct is to celebrate. The session's warning: be a little sceptical. Easy yeses sometimes get used as exit moves. The buyer creates a complication (a logistics question, a payment-method question, anything) that requires the rep to go away and come back. Then they don't pick up the callback. The whole "yes" was a polite way to end the call.

How to test the easy yes:

5. If they want to pay up-front, offer them a small deposit instead and start today.
6. If they want the bigger package, confirm the timeline and book the next step inside the same call.
7. If they want to start tomorrow, send the proposal and the deposit link before hanging up.
8. Each of these tests removes the gap the buyer would have used as an exit. If the yes is real, they take the path. If it was an exit, the energy changes immediately.

8. The closing happens at the information stage

A reframe of where the close actually lives. New reps think the close is a moment at the end of the pitch — "so, can we get this signed up?" Experienced reps know the close happened during the discovery and pitch. By the time the rep says "so, do you want to go ahead?" the answer has already been decided. If the info stage was strong, the close is just clicking the button. If the info stage was weak, no closing technique in the world will save it.

"The closing will happen when it happens. The close is closed at the information stage. If you got that right, the close is just the formality."

The implication for how to spend the call:

- 90% of the rep's effort goes into the information stage — discovery, alignment, demonstration, value framing.
- 10% goes into the close itself. The close is a confirmation move, not a persuasion move.
- If the close is hard, that's a signal the info stage was incomplete. Don't push the close — go back and fill the gap.

9. You don't need to know when they'll close — you need to know when they're not

The most important reframe of the session. Most reps spend their energy trying to predict when a buyer will say yes. That's a wasted effort — yeses happen when they happen. The far more useful question is: when will the buyer say no? Because a no is information, and information lets the rep clear the deck and move on. The fear of "no" is what keeps marginal deals on the pipeline for weeks, costing the rep time on real opportunities.

"You don't need to know when they close. You need to know when they're not interested. That's the irony of selling. You're actually frightened of no — but no is the thing you want, because it's clean."

The mental shift:

- Treat "no" as a finished conversation, not a personal rejection.
- Move marginal deals toward no faster, so real deals get the rep's attention.
- A clear no is more valuable than a polite maybe — it returns the rep's time, which is the rep's most expensive resource.

10. Quality over quantity — one good booking beats seventeen distracted ones

The closing principle of the session. A rep with seventeen bookings spread across the week and no time to research, no time to focus, no time to apply urgency on any single one will produce worse results than a rep with one or two bookings they've prepared for properly. The session wasn't arguing for fewer leads — it was arguing for tighter focus per lead.

"I'd rather have one booking and go: this is the one I'm going to spend an hour and a half with, and close it down for sure."

What focused preparation looks like:

- Find a quiet spot in the office. No interruptions.
- Research the buyer's business properly — turnover, staff, competitors, recent activity.
- Plan the pitch end-to-end, including the likely objections and the responses.
- Block the calendar around the pitch — at least 90 minutes, ideally two hours.
- Apply urgency inside that window. Close in the conversation, not next week.

11. Action items this week

9. When a buyer asks a question you can't answer instantly, use the 5-minute callback. Don't schedule it for tomorrow.
10. Practise the "one better" move — have the bonus pre-authorised so it's ready when you need it.
11. On every Monday pitch, aim to close on the call. Treat "Friday" as a buyer comfort answer, not a real commitment.
12. If a buyer doesn't pick up, send the short text-message recovery. One text, then wait.
13. Test every easy yes — offer the smaller path that would commit them today. Watch how their energy responds.
14. Track which deals are still open with no information stage completed. Those are the deals to close (as a no) this week.
15. Cap weekly bookings. Choose two or three to pour effort into. Prepare for those properly.

THE ONE-LINER Urgency is a tempo, not a panic. Hold the line. Call back in five. Close on Monday. Find the no fast.